1. What I'm building

I am building a platform to help users discover and trust beauty professionals more easily. The goal is to improve how clients find, compare, and connect and know what to expect with professionals before booking a service.

It's a vertical marketplace focused on trust and decision-making in the beauty services space.

I'm **focus** on

- Discovery
- Trust
- Pre-booking confidence

<u>Be the place people go BEFORE booking.</u>

2. Problem

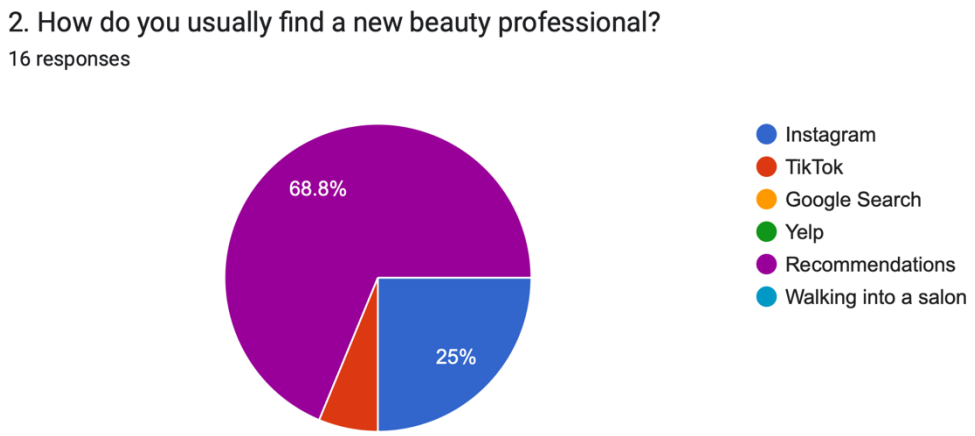
From survey:

Many clients struggle to confidently choose beauty professionals due to:

- Lack of trust and transparency
- Difficulty identifying reliable reviews
- Poor communication before booking
- Uncertainty about quality, pricing, and professionalism

Clients struggle to confidently choose beauty professionals because current platforms like social media lack trust, transparency, and clear signals of quality—leading them to rely heavily on word-of-mouth instead.

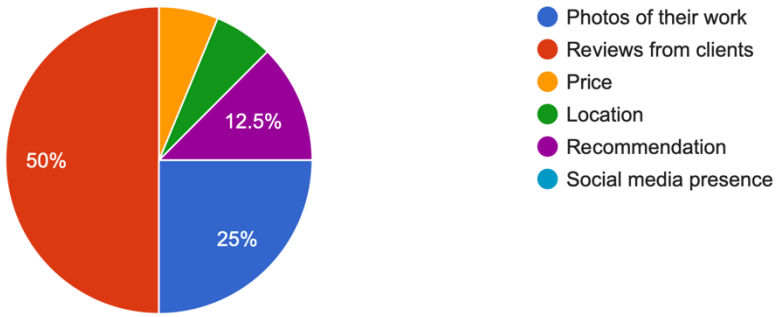
3. Key Insights



68.8% rely on recommendations to find professionals

3. What matters MOST when choosing a beauty professional?

16 responses

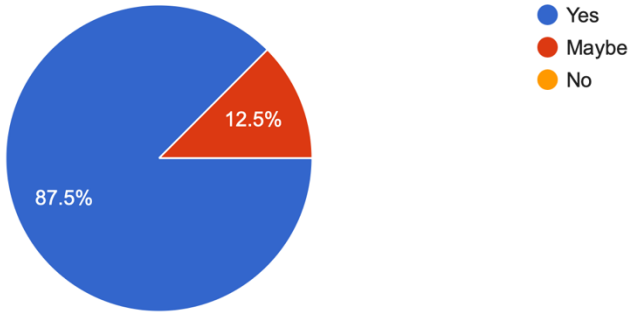


50% say reviews are the most important factor

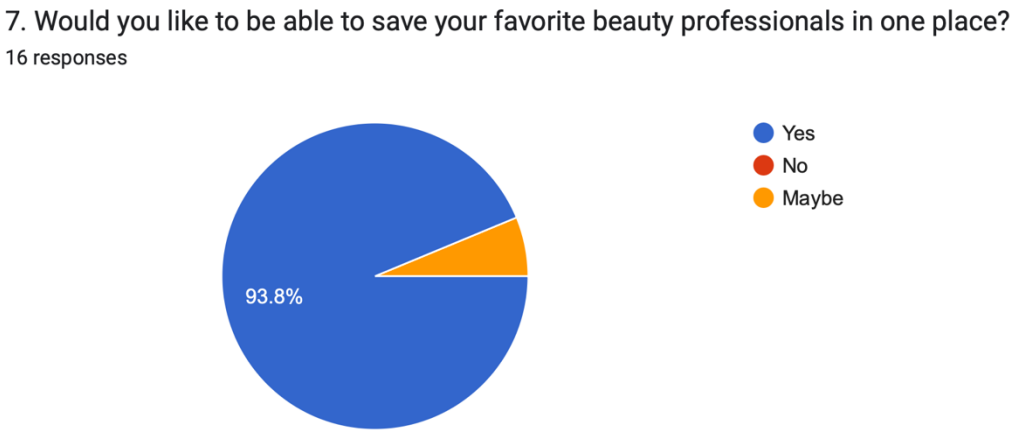
- Many users mentioned trust, communication, and "red flags" as major concerns

6. If there was a platform where you could discover beauty professionals (with portfolios, reviews, pricing, and services in one place), would you use it?

16 responses



86.7% said they would use a platform like this



93.3% want to save favorite professionals

From our survey, 68.8% of users rely on recommendations rather than platforms, while over 50% say reviews are the most important factor. However, many users expressed difficulty identifying trustworthy professionals and recognizing red flags. This shows that the core problem is not discovery, but trust and feel confidence before booking.

4. Proposed Solution

A discovery-first platform that focuses on trust, allowing users to:

- Explore verified beauty professionals
- View authentic reviews and portfolios
- Message professionals before booking
- Save and compare options

5. Key Differentiation

Lumina is a trust-first discovery platform that helps clients confidently choose beauty professionals before booking, using verified results, authentic reviews, and transparent communication signals.

TRADITIONAL MARKETPLACE (WHAT OTHERS DO):

- Find provider
- Book
- Pay

Focus = transaction

My marketplace:

- Discover
- Evaluate
- Trust
- Then book (maybe later)

Focus = decision confidence

6. Initial Features (MVP)

Simple first

1. Landing page
2. Professional profiles (portfolio, pricing, reviews)
3. Discovery feed (recommended / featured)
4. Save favorites

Option 1: VERIFIED RESULTS SYSTEM

Instead of just reviews:

- Clients upload:
  - Before/after photos
  - Tagged to real appointments
- Verified badge = real client

Option 2: RED FLAG / GREEN FLAG SYSTEM

Let users see:

❌ Late responses
❌ No-show complaints
❌ Hidden pricing
✅ On-time
✅ Transparent pricing
✅ Consistent results

7. Business Model

👉 **Professionals can be listed for free (basic)**

👉 **They can choose to subscribe (paid)**

This is called a **freemium model** (very common, very smart for marketplaces)

Revenue will come from beauty professionals through:

1. **Subscription (main model)**

- monthly fee to be listed + discovered
- includes profile, exposure, and leads

2. **Featured placement**

- professionals can pay to be shown higher in search or feed

3. **Premium tools (later)**

- analytics (profile views, saves)
- client insights
- messaging tools

> "It's free for clients, and the idea is professionals would eventually pay for visibility and exposure — but only if it actually helps them get more clients. Right now I'm just testing and building based on feedback."

So what does FREE include?

Free listing (basic profile)

- name
- services
- pricing
- location
- portfolio (limited)
- basic visibility

👉 This lowers the barrier = more artists join

What does PAID (subscription) include?

You are selling:

👉 **more visibility + more clients**

🟣 Subscription (example features)

1. Boosted visibility

- show higher in search
- appear in “featured” sections

MAIN value

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2. More exposure

- shown to more nearby clients
- prioritized in recommendations

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3. Full portfolio

- more images
- better presentation

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4. Insights (this is powerful later)

- how many people viewed your profile
- how many saved you

5. Faster responses / badges

- “responds fast”
- “top artist”
- “trusted”

💬

“How do you make money?”

Say:

“Right now it’s free for clients.

Long term, professionals would pay for visibility — like being featured or getting more exposure — but only if it actually brings them clients.”

“What do you mean by visibility?”

Say:

“Like being shown higher in search, being featured, or getting more exposure to clients nearby.

“Would I have to pay?”

Say:

“Not right now. I’m just testing it first.

Eventually it would only make sense to charge if it actually helps you get clients.”

“Why would I pay for this instead of Instagram?”

Say:

“Instagram is more about posting content, but it’s hard for clients to compare or trust before booking.

This is more focused on helping clients choose you confidently.”